

Policy

Board member attendance

Approved by the Board of Directors: May 7, 2026

Policy brief & purpose

This policy establishes the expectations and requirements regarding the attendance of meetings by members of the Board of Directors (the "Board") to ensure diligent and consistent governance of the organization.

Policy elements

Here we outline our general rules regarding Board member meeting attendance.

1. Meeting scheduling

We recognise that scheduling for an international board is complex and finding timings that are inclusive for all locations is hard. Attendance is expected on a best effort basis in light of these constraints, and our expectation is for clear communication and commitment when meeting attendance is possible.

2. Attendance requirement

All Board Directors are expected to attend each scheduled meeting of the Board, recognizing that active participation is crucial for effective governance and decision-making.

3. Permissible absences

Each Board Director is allowed to be absent from one (1) meeting per fiscal year without the need for a prior explanation but should submit an explanation to the secretary (via secretary@datadryad.org) for sharing with the Executive Committee as soon as possible. This allowance recognizes that unforeseen circumstances can prevent attendance.

4. Exceeding absence limit

If a Board Director misses two or more (2) meetings within the same year of service, the Board is obligated to review and consider the nature and reasons behind the absences at the second such missing meeting.

The Board will assess if the circumstances leading to the absences are extraordinary or if they reflect the Director's inability to fulfill their obligations as a member of the Board.

5. Determination of Board member status

In accordance with Article 5, Section 13 of the Bylaws, the remaining members of the Board, exercising reasonable discretion, will determine if a Director, due to their absence, is deemed unable to fulfill their duties.

This determination will be made based on the nature of the absences, the Director's overall contribution to the Board, and their ability to fulfill responsibilities as stipulated in the Bylaws and Board policy.

6. Procedure following determination

If the Board, after careful consideration, concludes that the Director is unable to meet their obligations due to excessive absences, appropriate actions in line with the organization's Bylaws will be taken.

Determination will be made by majority vote at a Board meeting, post Director having been notified of the upcoming vote, and given an opportunity to respond.

The process will be triggered by motion at a prior Board meeting.

This may lead to requesting the resignation of the Director or declaring the position vacant in accordance with the established Bylaws.

7. Documentation and communication

All deliberations and decisions regarding Board attendance and Director status shall be properly documented in the minutes of the Board meetings.

Directors shall be promptly informed of any concerns regarding their attendance and any subsequent decisions made by the Board in relation to their ability to fulfill their duties.

8. Review of attendance policy

This policy shall be reviewed periodically, and any amendments will be made in accordance with the procedures set forth in the Bylaws.

By adherence to this policy, the Board ensures that its members are actively involved in governance and decision-making processes, thereby upholding the integrity and effectiveness of the Board's role in the organization.